

mature now. Perhaps what used to be people problems are now ways to help others.

To get more out of your career you have to stretch a little. A man I know used to teach private English lessons in Madrid. He saw about ten people a week and charged \$15 an hour. But he got fed up with the constant promotional push to attract new students. "I'm an English teacher, not a hustler," he griped. He finally got rid of his private students and took a \$3-an-hour job in a language institute.

This man is now working forty hours a week instead of ten. He's earning \$120 a week instead of \$150. True, he doesn't do any promotional work. But seeing students forty hours a week leaves him feeling beat up and exhausted.

This man now thinks he made a mistake. "With word of mouth alone I could have maintained an average of five or six students," he told me. "And I could have hired a kid one day a week to make phone calls, place ads, and do the other stuff I hated."

When did you last stretch in your job? Agree to take on a slightly unpleasant task to get ahead? Take the initiative to learn more about jobs in your area or another area? Ask for a transfer to a new department with a more exciting future? And don't forget the basics: when was the last time you asked for a raise or promotion?

I'm not suggesting you "sell out," give up what you most enjoy, or take on duties that make you sick. But I am suggesting that you stretch. With a bit of willpower you can handle a bigger job. Make the right moves at the office and you could find yourself making bigger bucks and enjoying work more than ever.

A friend recently left her personnel job and went into sales. For the first time in her life, she's making cold telephone calls. To handle the stress she keeps a sign on her desk that says "I'm stretching." Whenever she makes a cold call—or does anything else she's never done before—she holds the "I'm stretching" sign for her assistant to